What is AI

Teacher reference

Original classroom activities for Year 2. Use teacher-led demonstrations, prepared predictions and non-personal pictures.

Know the difference

Some AI systems use patterns learned from examples to make predictions, such as guessing what an image shows. A simple timer follows fixed instructions. A device being called smart does not tell us whether it uses AI.

Try it

Give pairs six picture cards: timer, calculator, a basic Scratch movement script, a described picture-recognition system, a speech-recognition system and an unfamiliar gadget.

Sort the cards into uses AI in this example, fixed instructions, and need more information. Ask pupils to explain one choice. Do not guess about an unknown gadget.

Check

Ask for one AI example and one program that follows fixed instructions. Can the pupil explain the difference in simple words?

Teacher sources

AI4K12 grade-band progression charts (K-2): https://ai4k12.org/gradeband-progression-charts/

UNICEF Guidance on AI and Children: https://www.unicef.org/innocenti/reports/policy-guidance-ai-children